Day 25 - Bennett Heritage Trail, Great Esker, North Rim, Duff Pit, Trafalgar, Eighth Line

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 33 · Silver Creek and Scotsdale Farm

11.8 km / 7.3 mi	~3.4 h	7.7 km new	47 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside parking on the eastern shoulder of Eighth Line at the southernmost intersection with 27 Sideroad. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day25_hike033.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Bennett Heritage Trail (3.8 km); Great Esker Side Trail (1.0 km); North Rim Side Trail (0.9 km); Duff Pit Side Trail (0.8 km); Trafalgar Side Trail (0.7 km); Eighth Line Side Trail (0.4 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside on the eastern shoulder of Eighth Line at the southernmost intersection with 27 Sideroad. A trip report mentions Snow's Creek Falls at this intersection, a short detour. Area parking can fill on weekends.
- **Bennett Heritage Trail:** Starts at Scotsdale Farm and passes a pond with a weeping willow, then crosses Snow's Creek and Owl Creek. Credit Valley Conservation rates it difficult.
- **Great Esker Side Trail:** Runs partly along the top of an esker, a rare glacial sand-and-gravel ridge, about 30 m above the land around it. Look for old stone fences, granite boulders and a rusting 1940s car. Poison ivy grows along the edges; keep Zappy to the path.
- **Road walking:** A stretch of the Duff Pit Side Trail follows a road shoulder; keep Zappy close and walk single file facing traffic.
- **Other side trails:** No descriptions were found for the Duff Pit, North Rim, Trafalgar or Eighth Line side trails. Silver Creek trails in general have steep slopes, rocks and roots; CVC recommends carrying a Bruce Trail map.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Silver Creek Education Centre: Enter from Fallbrook Trail northwest of the 27th Sideroad map	Free	0.8	1200 m	
P3	In the laneway off the west side of Eighth Line where the Bennett Heritage Trail crosses map	Free	2.8	120 m	Bennett Heritage Trail
P4	Scotsdale Farm: Enter from Trafalgar Rd, 1.7 km northwest of Highway 7 map	Free	3.7	0 m	Bennett Heritage Trail
P5	Roadside parking across from the Eighth Line Side Trail on Eighth Line map	Free	10.1	0 m	Eighth Line, Great Esker

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions

0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on the eastern shoulder of Eighth Line at the southernmost intersection…. Walk about 190 m to the trail. Head east on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail.
1.0	0.6	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Bennett Heritage Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
2.9	1.8	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Bennett Heritage Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Maureen Smith Side Trail goes off on your left (optional extra: Maureen Smith Side Trail, 0.7 km, mostly on road, not in the plan).) There is trailhead parking here (In the laneway off the west side of Eighth Line where the Bennett Heritage Trail crosses).
4.7	2.9	J3: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
6.0	3.7	J4: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Duff Pit Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
6.1	3.8	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
6.8	4.2	J5: Turn left onto the blue-blazed North Rim Side Trail, heading north-east. (the blue-blazed Duff Pit Side Trail goes off ahead.)
7.7	4.8	J6: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Trafalgar Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Trafalgar Side Trail goes off on your right.)
8.4	5.2	J7: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail goes off ahead.)
9.0	5.6	J8: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
9.3	5.8	J9: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
9.7	6.0	J10: Turn sharp left onto the blue-blazed Eighth Line Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail goes off ahead.)
10.1	6.3	J11: End of the Eighth Line Side Trail. There is trailhead parking here (Roadside parking across from the Eighth Line Side Trail on Eighth Line). Turn around and retrace your steps.
10.4	6.5	J10: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Great Esker Side Trail goes off on your left.)
10.8	6.7	J9: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
11.8	7.3	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails, Hiking the GTA and Credit Valley Conservation.